

news feed

DIGIT JULY 2003

hypothesis

Serial Attached SCSI

■ What is it?

The prototype version of Serial Attached SCSI (SAS) developed by HP, Seagate and Adaptec. This technology is expected to be a step ahead of a lower-end, but increasingly powerful standard-Serial ATA (SATA).

■ How does it work?

Data is transferred through a small number of high-speed serial wires, instead of a large number of parallel wires. SAS can accept cables upto 8 metres in length. It uses thin cables instead of the usual broad ribbon cables that obstruct the airflow inside PC cabinets. SAS has a transfer rate of up to 3 Gbps. Vibrations misalign ATA drive components, slowing performance, but SCSI drives can withstand more motion.

■ What does it do?

SAS is a sequel to SCSI drives, used for jobs done by servers where every whit of performance matters. SAS will be adopted for demanding server tasks such as databases with a heavy transaction rate.

snapshot

80 per cent of children using e-mail receive spam on a daily basis

Source: Symantec

Unique code

In an amendment to its lawsuit filed in March 2003, Santa Cruz Operation (SCO) seeks at least \$1 billion in damages from IBM's alleged breach of its contract with SCO; another \$1 billion for breach of the Unix contract signed by Sequent, which IBM acquired in 1999; and another \$1 billion for unfair competition. The suit specifically blames Linus

Torvalds for allowing proprietary Unix code into Linux.

SCO claims IBM has made multiprocessor operating system technology available for free distribution to anyone in the world, which can be used for anything, including development of weapons of mass destruction. SCO also accuses

that IBM of copying its Remote Copy Update (RCU) system, for relieving some memory bottlenecks on multiprocessor servers.

Recently, SCO uncovered a 1996 amendment to the contract, under which Novell sold many of its Unix assets to SCO's predecessor, Santa Cruz Corporation. Now, SCO Group has revoked IBM's license to sell its

version of Unix, called AIX. It said that this termination not only applies to new business by IBM, but also existing copies of AIX that are installed at all customer sites, thus all of it has to be destroyed.

IBM maintains that it has done nothing wrong and that its customers need not worry.



ILLUSTRATIONS: Farzana Cooper

Matrix Reloaded, offloaded!

Matrix Reloaded has been banned in Egypt. The country's censorship board was concerned about the storyline, which revolves around the search for the God and control of the human race. Violence scenes were also cited as a reason for the ban. While the committee, consisting of 15 critics, academics, writers and psychologists, gave credit to the movie's fabulous

effects; it felt the movie handles sensitive issues related to three divine religions. Also, it added that these issues have caused a crisis previously. Thus, they felt that screening the movie could cause trouble and harm social peace. This press too, added fuel to the fire by launching a campaign against the Jewish and Zionist ideas portrayed in the movie.



Earn Money from Unreal!

Nvidia, and the makers of *Unreal Tournament* are offering prizes amounting to \$1,000,000 in search of great mods. For *UT 2003*, or the unreleased *UT 2004*. The contest is divided into best mod, best character, best use of 3D sound, and best real-time non-interactive movie.

The winners also receive a UT game engine license and high performance PC hardware. To participate, all you need to do is develop a free working mod, and then register at www.makesomethingunreal.com/. The contest is divided into three levels and the results will be announced in The Game Developers Conference, San Jose in 2004. The contest also serves as a talent hunt for the developers who are most likely to hire the winner for future projects.



*see offer on page 94-95 →

■ Since 1978, more than 1 billion Intel x86 processors have been sold ■ Intel takes the Pentium 4-M beyond the 3 GHz mark